■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Monday, September 21, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *Gio Reyna relishing his new leadership role with French club that bodes well for USMNT chances*

The Angle: *Reyna's a name US soccer fans actually know, and with the World Cup landing on home soil in 2026, any sign he's leveling up matters way beyond one fanbase.*

- **Gio Reyna** transferred to French club **Strasbourg** this past summer.
- He's reportedly stepping into a genuine leadership role there — not just a bench piece.
- The buzz: his growth in France could directly translate to a bigger role for the **USMNT**.

The World Cup Watch

- If Reyna's finally leveling up overseas, does he start for the US at the 2026 World Cup?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/21/sports/how-gio-reynas-role-at-strasbourg-is-helping-him-his-usmnt-chances/

■ *Boy with Autism, 10, Hailed Hero After Alerting Mom to 'Giant' Kitchen Fire, Calmly Carrying His Baby Sister to Safety*

The Angle: *A kid hero story with an autism-representation angle - a 10-year-old calmly spotted a raging kitchen fire, got mom's attention, and carried his baby sister to safety. It's the kind of feel-good, share-it-with-everyone story that's built for a morning show.*

- The hero here is just **10 years old** - and he's autistic.
- He alerted his mom to what's being called a **"giant" kitchen fire**.
- While the fire raged, he **calmly carried his baby sister** to safety.
- He's now being **hailed as a hero** for how he handled it.

The Feel-Good Moment

- Call it in: what's the most impressive thing your kid has ever done under pressure?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/boy-with-autism-10-honored-after-alerting-mom-to-kitchen-fire-saving-sister-12125946

■ *Part of the Aral Sea is coming back to life. Kazakhstan's Kok Aral Dam increased water volume in the northern lake by 68%, cut salinity in half and more than tripled fish production, while Uzbekistan has planted 4.2 million acres of the exposed lakebed with hardy vegetation.*

The Angle: *One of the world's most infamous environmental disasters is quietly reversing course — a rare good-news story about humans actually undoing ecological damage, and that kind of comeback tale plays huge with a general audience.*

- **Kazakhstan's Kok Aral Dam** boosted water volume in the northern Aral Sea by **68%**
- Salinity in that section has been **cut in half**
- Fish production has **more than tripled** since the dam went in
- **Uzbekistan** has replanted **4.2 million acres** of the dried-up lakebed with hardy vegetation

The Feel-Good Angle

- Name one other environmental disaster you'd love to see make a comeback like this.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/aral-sea-ships-desert-restoration/36992/

■ *Canadian investigation launched into data breach that exposed millions of IDs*

The Angle: *Millions of driver's licenses and government IDs from both Canada and the U.S. got exposed in a breach, and Canada's privacy watchdog is now investigating - this hits basically anyone who's had to scan an ID for age verification or a rental in the last few years.*

- Canada's **Privacy Commissioner** has officially launched an investigation into the breach
- The company at the center is **IDScan.net**
- The exposure reportedly includes **millions** of driver's licences and other government-issued ID
- Data affected people in **both Canada and the U.S.**, making it a cross-border story

The Debate Starter

- Call in: does it freak you out how many random places ask you to scan your ID, and are you rethinking that next time?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/idscan-net-data-breach-id-canada-9.7352859?cmp=rss

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■ *'Line of Fire' Review: Peter Krause and Hope Davis Lead NBC's Silly but Diverting Law Enforcement Family Drama*

The Angle: *NBC just bet big on a show where literally every branch of federal law enforcement is run by one dysfunctional family - critics are calling it ridiculous but can't stop watching, which is basically the whole appeal.*

- **Peter Krause** and **Hope Davis** lead the cast as the heads of the **Hollingsworth family**
- Family members are scattered across the **Secret Service**, **FBI**, **U.S. Marshals**, and the **Department of Justice**
- Created by **Joshua Safran**, the same mind behind **'Quantico'**
- **Hollywood Reporter**'s review calls it **"silly but diverting"**

The Debate Starter

- One family running the entire federal government's law enforcement arm - too silly to work, or exactly silly enough to be a guilty-pleasure hit?

www.hollywoodreporter.com (Tier 3) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 4 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/tv/tv-reviews/line-of-fire-review-nbc-hope-davis-peter-krause-1236700815/

Backup options:

■ *Hideo Kojima Says Sony Dropped PHYSINT During a Zoom Call and Gave No Reason - TechPowerUp*

The Angle: *One of gaming's most legendary creators says PlayStation cut a project with him and didn't even bother to say why - that's the kind of corporate cold shoulder that gets people talking, famous name or not.*

- **Hideo Kojima** says **Sony/PlayStation** ended its involvement in his game **PHYSINT** during a **Zoom call in June**
- Kojima told **IGN** that Sony gave **no reason** for pulling out
- He admits he **didn't ask many questions** during that call
- Kojima says Sony **hasn't been in touch since**

The Debate Starter

- Would you just accept a breakup like that over Zoom with zero explanation, or would you have demanded answers on the spot?

Techpowerup.com (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 77/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 20 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techpowerup.com/352884/hideo-kojima-says-sony-dropped-physint-during-a-zoom-call-and-gave-no-reason

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Prince William spoke to Carney and shared his 'long-standing affection for Canada' | Phone conversation between sitting prime minister and the heir apparent is unusual*

The Angle: *A future king personally phoning a sitting prime minister isn't standard royal protocol, so this one's got people talking about why William wanted Ottawa to hear it straight from him.*

- **Prince William** placed a phone call directly to PM **Mark Carney**
- William told Carney he has a "**long-standing affection for Canada**"
- A direct call between the heir apparent and a sitting PM is described as **unusual**

The Debate Starter

- Is this genuine Canadian love or a smart PR move while royal relevance is being questioned back home?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/prince-william-carney-call-9.7352307

■ *Carney, Lula urge nations to join group to unite middle powers*

The Angle: *Canada's PM is publicly courting other mid-sized nations to band together on the world stage - a signal Canada wants more clout when the big powers (US, China) are calling the shots.*

- **Mark Carney** (Canada) and **Lula** (Brazil) are jointly urging other countries to join a new coalition
- The pitch is built around uniting so-called **'middle powers'** - countries that aren't superpowers but still carry weight
- No word yet on which countries have signed on or what the group's concrete agenda is

The Debate Starter

- Should Canada be out there forming its own power bloc, or is this just diplomatic theater with no teeth?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://financialpost.com/news/economy/carney-lula-urge-nations-unite-middle-powers

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■ *U.S. shouldn't buy 'blood potash' from Belarus, Sask. premier says*

The Angle: *Saskatchewan's premier is putting a fertilizer ingredient into the geopolitics conversation, branding Belarusian potash "blood potash" and pushing the U.S. to cut it off - a direct shot at a regime propped up by Russia, and a not-so-subtle pitch for Saskatchewan's own potash industry to fill the gap.*

- **Scott Moe**, Saskatchewan's premier, is calling on the **U.S.** to stop buying potash from **Belarus**
- He's branding it **"blood potash"** - tying the trade directly to the **Belarusian regime**
- Saskatchewan is one of the **world's largest potash producers**, giving the premier a direct stake in who the U.S. buys from

The Debate Starter

- Should a fertilizer's country of origin be a political litmus test, or is this just Saskatchewan looking out for its own industry?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/saskatchewan/us-blood-potash-belarus-premier-9.7352852?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■■ *Denmark, Greenland set to sign security deal with U.S. on Tuesday*

The Angle: *Months after Trump kept floating the idea of the U.S. just taking Greenland, the island's actually getting a formal security deal — and Denmark's framing it as a way to keep Washington in check by looping in NATO.*

- **Denmark**, **Greenland** and the **U.S.** sign the security agreement on **Tuesday**
- **Denmark** says the deal puts **Arctic security** under **NATO's** watch, not just Washington and Copenhagen alone
- Comes after a year of tension over **Trump's** repeated interest in the U.S. acquiring **Greenland**

The Debate Starter

- Is this Denmark cleverly boxing in Trump's Greenland ambitions, or just handing the U.S. a bigger foothold in the Arctic anyway?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/denmark-greenland-us-security-deal-9.7353071?cmp=rss

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■ *Christopher Liew: What the average Canadian retiree actually lives on*

The Angle: *Retirement math is one of those quiet anxieties everyone's carrying around - CPP, OAS, savings, the whole puzzle - so a real number attached to "average retiree income" is instant relatable water-cooler talk for anyone over 30.*

The Phone-In Trigger

- Guess the number: what do you think the average Canadian retiree actually brings in each year - then call in and tell us if you're on track to beat it.

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMirwFBVV95cUxPQXhCS3RzN2IxT21LOFBaSUlvZDFiNFdVNDA3WnJ4cmpLNzhyTGhIMmc4ZGxKS2g3TVVoelV0T1U5alVKNlJ6QXNscXA1cjl6SnQtbFFTM0V5TnlXMFlEVVA3RXc0bHlwOXNQUVdzR3pSYkN1aGlUTnE0Szc1blVWdTQ2ZENCNVBhcW9IcXFfaHdOanV4TlNHSmF2ay1SMS16T2VfRm5lZEpDbGhMS0M4?oc=5

■ *Here's how Buy Canadian scanner apps did on identifying food origins*

The Angle: *With the Buy Canadian movement still going strong amid trade tension with the U.S., these origin-scanning apps have become a go-to tool at the grocery store — but a new check-up on their accuracy is raising the obvious question: can you actually trust what they're telling you?*

The Debate Starter

- Have you used one of these Buy Canadian apps — and did it actually get the origin right, or send you on a wild goose chase?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiqgFBVV95cUxNRVBZT040YkZXVHg2cFVsSUFXQVpQM0VqOVoyYmNrSFctVHF6QUY1bGpLS0UxYjN5bjFQZGVHQmVoWmtiaVltSG9DQWE5QjFzMm0wbWkxSGtRSWp3czUwbEFhOXVPcWhIdzByNG1HbTBhbHdCTzA3YzBPZG5NUkxkVU5ORVVmMHFKN3l5RDdnRTkyd2JaZnRXS2xmX0JTdlBORW8tU0x6X01xQQ?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Channing Tatum Debunks Fan Speculation of a Secret Instagram Account: 'If I Really Need to Say It, I Only Have One' - People.com*

The Angle: *Fans went digging and thought they found Channing Tatum's secret burner Instagram — he just shot it down himself, which is exactly the kind of celebrity internet-sleuthing chatter that gets a segment going.*

- **Channing Tatum** publicly denied fan speculation about a secret Instagram account
- His response: **'If I Really Need to Say It, I Only Have One'**
- Story is developing — full details limited to the headline at this time

The Debate Starter

- Would you ever run a secret 'finsta,' or is that a celebrity-only move?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMikAFBVV95cUxPM0xTZjRjU1lsX1l3MGVQMGdPcERvVlVhYUpoMkpZTHFSQkRYbFNIb2tmQU4wdnF1YlpHTF9PSzI4Z2d6dWFPVlhuZkZSVk5LSW80azFGZG5WbDJVV2V5Z1dndGw2S2pFSC14dGxVSFNPc1psMDhFZ0lsS3pq

X1FneGk1S08yWXI0WmZRTDhzS3E?oc=5

■ *William Shatner Performs Ozzy, Metallica, Motörhead Classics at His Debut Metal Show*

The Angle: *William Shatner headbanging through Ozzy and Metallica at a Chicago club is the kind of gloriously unhinged pop culture moment that's built for a live read - it's funny, it's oddly inspiring, and it's just bizarre enough that listeners will want to see the clips.*

- **William Shatner**, age **95**, played his debut metal show at a Chicago club
- The setlist reportedly included covers of **Ozzy Osbourne**, **Metallica**, and **Motörhead**
- The gig came ahead of his booked appearance at **Riot Fest**
- Yes, that's the same **Shatner** who played **Captain Kirk** on Star Trek

The Debate Starter

- What's the most unexpected celebrity genre-swap you've ever seen live - and does 95-year-old Shatner doing Metallica beat it?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://consequence.net/2026/09/william-shatner-debut-metal-show/

■ *Robin Williams' Daughter Calls for Fans Creating AI Videos of the Actor to 'Have Some Shame': 'Leave Him Out of Your Delusional Bulls—'*

The Angle: *AI deepfakes of dead celebrities are spiraling out of control, and now Robin Williams' own daughter Zelda is publicly calling out the fans making them - a real gut-check on where AI 'tributes' cross into disrespect.*

- **Zelda Williams**, daughter of the late **Robin Williams**, is speaking out against fans making **AI-generated videos** of her father.
- Her message to them: 'have some shame.'
- She didn't hold back, telling people to 'leave him out of your delusional bulls—.'

The Debate Starter

- Is AI-generated 'tribute' content to a dead star sweet fandom or flat-out disrespectful - where's the line?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/robin-williams-daughter-ai-videos-1236871568/

■ *AI 'actress' Tilly Norwood glitches during Piers Morgan interview*

The Angle: *Tilly Norwood is the AI-generated 'actress' that's already got Hollywood in an uproar over AI replacing real performers — and now she's glitching live on camera, which is basically free ammo for anyone who thinks this whole thing is a gimmick.*

- **Tilly Norwood**, the controversial AI-generated "actress," malfunctioned during a live interview with **Piers Morgan**.
- **Morgan** called her out on camera: **'You seem to be speaking Chinese completely randomly for no reason. Why did you do that?'**

The Debate Starter

- Would you ever watch a movie starring an AI actress — glitches, random Mandarin and all?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/entertainment/celebrity/ai-actress-tilly-norwood-glitches-piers-morgan-interview

Backup options:

■■ *Princess Diana's Brother, Charles Spencer: His Most Raw Interview Ever - People.com*

The Angle: *Earl Charles Spencer rarely does interviews about his sister or his own life, so when People calls it his "most raw" ever, that's a signal there's real, unfiltered stuff in there worth digging into.*

The Curiosity Hook

- What's one thing you'd actually want to ask Princess Diana's brother if you had five minutes with him?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMixwFBVV95cUxPUW1iekpvbmhvYWd0NmxkLVhwRlpoOEpfMHYyRGF0RS1qVWdCdkdhODE0c3Y2aHpDMUNWZG1LMU5VamxhM2tKM2EtcmpkUzFudWlqZnBXS19MME5fTmR6SUFMNFhLYlRpdVJFZ3JFTHVRYlkzSUNQY2dscUJ2c1lVeU5Sc3ZIYTVtamZrYUpQUF9ZdEZLY2RIbWYzNnVDX2VIMzFyWUFZU0hUOHFCbXQ5RXZLZnctSWJ6NDJPLTl0ZVBWbEtFbUVr?oc=5

■ *Ke Huy Quan on Receiving “Generous” $100K Residuals Check for ‘Indiana Jones and the Temple of Doom’ - hollywoodreporter.com*

The Angle: *The Oscar winner is going viral for revealing he had no idea residual checks existed as a kid actor on Indiana Jones - it's a fun, relatable rags-to-riches nugget from a beloved comeback star.*

- **Ke Huy Quan** received a **$100,000** residual check as a child for **'Indiana Jones and the Temple of Doom'**
- He said he **"didn't understand how more money could suddenly appear"** after already being paid for his work
- The 1984 Steven Spielberg film was Quan's early breakout role
- Quan later won the **Oscar** for Best Supporting Actor for 'Everything Everywhere All at Once'

The Nostalgia Hit

- What's the most money you were shocked to get unexpectedly as a kid?

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/ke-huy-quan-100k-residuals-check-temple-of-doom-1236706633/

■ *Ben Affleck Almost Cast Ex-Wife Jennifer Garner In 'Animals' - Variety*

The Angle: *It's Bennifer 2.0 energy — the hosts have a field day with exes who could've reunited on screen, and there's an easy 'imagine that awkward table read' angle for the show.*

- **Ben Affleck** directs and stars in **'Animals,'** premiering **Oct. 9** on Netflix
- He originally wanted ex-wife **Jennifer Garner** to play the leading lady
- A **scheduling conflict** forced him to step into the lead role himself

The Debate Starter

- Would you want to work with your ex right after a divorce — genius career move or way too messy?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/ben-affleck-ex-jennifer-garner-as-his-wife-in-animals-1236870451/

■ *Hayden Christensen’s 11-year-old daughter with ex Rachel Bilson makes red carpet debut - pagesix.com*

The Angle: *Celeb-kid milestones are easy watercooler fodder, and this one's got a sentimental angle since the event ties right into dad's own Star Wars legacy.*

- **Briar Rose**, the **11-year-old** daughter of **Hayden Christensen** and **Rachel Bilson**, walked her very first red carpet
- She held hands with dad **Hayden Christensen** on the carpet
- The event was the **Lucas Museum of Narrative Art** opening — a venue with obvious personal meaning for the former **Anakin Skywalker** actor
- Bilson and Christensen split years ago but are still clearly co-parenting through moments like this

The Debate Starter

- At what age is it actually okay to put your kid on a red carpet — is 11 too young for that spotlight?

Page Six (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://pagesix.com/2026/09/20/celebrity-news/hayden-christensens-11-year-old-daughter-with-ex-rachel-bilson-makes-red-carpet-debut/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *'Her face went real purple': Police defend technique after B.C. arrest video goes viral*

The Angle: *A bystander clip of a B.C. arrest is ripping through social media, and police are now on the defensive about the technique used — it's the kind of use-of-force debate that always gets phones ringing.*

- **British Columbia police** are publicly defending their arrest technique after video of the incident went viral.
- The clip includes a stark bystander description: **"Her face went real purple."**
- The footage has sparked wider public debate over policing tactics and when force crosses a line.

The Debate Starter

- Where's the line between a necessary restraint and something that should never make it onto video?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiswFBVV95cUxPOFVZb29mSEw5ZWJPX2hRQmxyajIyTXowZm8wRG1wV3ZOUmdnVmpvQ2tyVEVrNDBQZnFYc3RYd3NEOVBlNHpUdmN0VWJxMXFBNGlIdXNrVWRSVExla3FKZVQ4eEJ0RFliNFYxSUdnWlVnME11Vk9HR29MeDJxMFVlRm5jNnNMSExteERpWVVOdjBydm1lZXlYdmhxdlVRcEZFWXRYQ1pFOVQ3UTNXNjV1YWZ6VQ?oc=5

Backup options:

■ *California tech exec hits back at mockery over her viral list of dating 'non-negotiables' - The Independent*

The Angle: *A California tech exec posted her list of dating 'non-negotiables' online, got roasted for it, and is now firing back at critics — a classic viral standards-vs-mockery fight that doubles as a debate about dating culture (and SF's brutal dating scene specifically).*

- The exec's viral list of dating **'non-negotiables'** sparked online mockery before she publicly hit back at critics.
- One social media commenter's reply summed up the pile-on: **"I can't imagine anything worse than being single and dating in SF."**
- The story is out of **California's tech scene**, tying into the running narrative about how brutal dating is in **San Francisco** specifically.

The Debate Starter

- Ask listeners: read off your own dating 'non-negotiables' — reasonable standard or red flag?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Read Her List (or Your Own)** - Quick open, 30 seconds -> Hosts recap the viral 'non-negotiables' concept and each read one dating dealbreaker they'd never budge on.
- **Step 2: Reasonable or Ridiculous?** - Live call-out, 1-2 minutes -> Hosts vote on each other's non-negotiables as fair standards vs. picky nonsense, then open phones/text line for listeners to submit theirs.
- **Step 3: SF Dating Pile-On** - Wrap-up tag -> Close on the viral reply about SF dating being brutal — ask if listeners think their own city's dating scene is just as rough.

The-independent.com (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.the-independent.com/life-style/viral-dating-list-tech-executive-california-b3053232.html

■ *Converse apologizes, pulls ad that critics say evokes KKK and lynching imagery*

The Angle: *A major sneaker brand just got dragged so hard online - by a sitting congressman, celebrities, and marketing experts - that it pulled a national ad and apologized within days. That's a real brand crisis playing out in real time, and everyone's got an opinion on whether the backlash was fair.*

- **Converse** pulled the ad after backlash accusing it of evoking **Ku Klux Klan** and lynching imagery
- A **U.S. congressman** publicly weighed in against the ad
- Several **celebrities** and marketing experts joined the criticism online
- The company issued a formal **apology** alongside pulling the campaign

The Debate Starter

- Did Converse actually mess up, or did the internet see something in this ad that wasn't really there?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/converse-ad-apology-9.7351903?cmp=rss

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Christina Applegate Shares First Video Following Months-Long Hospitalization: 'Love to You All Out There'*

The Angle: *She's been open about her MS battle for years, so fans have been genuinely worried during this months-long hospitalization — this quick, upbeat check-in video is the kind of relatable 'good news' update that's easy to talk about on air.*

- **Christina Applegate** posted her first video since a **months-long hospital stay** tied to her ongoing **multiple sclerosis** battle.
- She showed off **fresh blonde hair color** in a **black zip-up hoodie**.
- Caption included: **"Fresh hair color, new weird..."** and **"Love to You All Out There."**
- She's best known for **"Married with Children"** and has been candid about her MS diagnosis since 2021.

The Feel-Good Check-In

- She's beaten expectations before — ask listeners to share the celebrity health update that made them tear up.

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/christina-applegate-ms-battle-1236871479/

Backup options:

■■ *Boomers love AI images of their grandkids; millennial parents hate it*

The Angle: *Every family has a group chat now, and apparently grandparents have discovered AI image generators to create fake photos of grandkids - millennial parents are not amused, and this is exactly the kind of generational tech clash that gets phones lighting up.*

The Family Group Chat Fight

- Has a relative ever sent you an AI-generated photo of your own kid - and how did you react?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.businessinsider.com/grandparents-ai-images-grandkids-privacy-parents-2026-9

■ *Research shows that people with low implicit self-worth, or a large mismatch between their conscious and unconscious self-esteem, are quicker to detect subtle facial expressions of anger and disgust.*

The Angle: *New psych research says people with shaky self-worth are actually better at catching subtle angry or disgusted faces before anyone else notices - a weirdly relatable 'am I like this?' moment for listeners.*

- **New research** finds people with low **implicit self-worth** are quicker to pick up on subtle facial expressions of **anger** and **disgust**.
- The effect shows up most when there's a big **mismatch between conscious and unconscious self-esteem** - basically, saying you're fine on the outside while your gut says otherwise.
- Translation: your brain may be running a hidden threat-detector tuned to rejection cues, even when you don't realize it.

The Self-Check

- Be honest, callers - do you always seem to clock when someone's secretly annoyed with you before they say a word?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/people-with-low-implicit-self-worth-are-quicker-to-notice-subtle-facial-cues-of-anger-and-disgust/

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *US communities blocked or delayed 45 proposed data center projects worth about $68 billion in the second quarter of 2026, as local opposition pushed cities and states to demand more consideration for electricity, water, land use and infrastructure.*

The Angle: *AI's building boom is running into actual humans with actual water bills and actual power grids - and the humans are winning. It's a fun reality check on how big tech's biggest trend hits a wall of local town halls.*

- **45 proposed data center projects** got blocked or delayed by local communities in Q2 2026
- Combined price tag on those stalled projects: roughly **$68 billion**
- Residents and local officials pushed back over strain on **electricity, water, land use and infrastructure**
- Cities and states are now demanding more say before greenlighting the next mega-server-farm

The Debate Starter

- Would you fight a data center moving into your town, or welcome the tax dollars and jobs?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/data-centers/local-opposition-blocked-usd68-billion-worth-of-data-center-projects-in-the-second-quarter-of-2026-data-center-investments-reportedly-still-on-track-to-hit-usd32-trillion-by-2050

Backup options:

■ *A daycare center in Fort Worth, Texas is being sued by a family after alleging the staff ran a "toddler fight club"*

The Angle: *It sounds like a made-up headline, but a Fort Worth family is suing a daycare over claims staff pitted toddlers against each other — and this isn't even the first time this exact allegation has popped up at a different daycare.*

- A family in **Fort Worth, Texas** is suing a daycare center, alleging staff orchestrated a **"toddler fight club"** among kids in their care.
- This is reportedly not an isolated incident — a nearly identical **"toddler fight club"** allegation surfaced at a daycare in a different state back in **2018**.

The WTF Reaction

- This is the second daycare "fight club" lawsuit like this — is anyone actually checking on these places?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fox4news.com/news/fort-worth-daycare-faces-lawsuit-after-video-allegedly-shows-substitute-encouraging-toddler-fights

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/5 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Internet Explorer is finally, truly dying, and Microsoft wants you ready by 2029*

The Angle: *It's the browser everyone already assumed was dead, but Microsoft just put a real tombstone date on it — 2029 — which is basically an excuse for a full internet-nostalgia eulogy on air.*

- **Microsoft** has set a firm target of **2029** to fully kill off any remaining traces of **Internet Explorer**
- IE was technically "retired" as Windows' default browser back in 2022, but lingering enterprise and legacy systems kept it on life support
- For a generation, IE was THE way onto the internet — before **Chrome**, before **Edge** — making this the final nail in a very nostalgic coffin

The Nostalgia Trip

- What's the first thing you ever Googled — or MSN-searched — through that little blue 'e' icon?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Eulogy for the 'e'** - 60-90 seconds, kick off the segment -> One host delivers a mock-serious eulogy for Internet Explorer while the other reacts like it's a real funeral
- **Step 2: Relic Roundup** - Quick callback bit -> Hosts trade memories/jokes about painfully slow load times, the spinning blue circle, and using IE just to download Chrome
- **Step 3: Phone Lines: RIP Requests** - Open call-in window -> Ask listeners to call in with their own '90s/2000s internet relic they want the show to eulogize next

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/113924-internet-explorer-finally-truly-dying-microsoft-wants-you.html

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■ *Texas police department ordered to close for failing to provide public benefit*

The Angle: *It's not a scandal, not corruption — a police department got ordered to close because officials say it simply wasn't benefiting the public. That's a wild premise that begs the question: what's a small-town police force actually supposed to prove to stay open?*

- A **Texas police department** has been ordered to shut down entirely.
- The stated reason: it failed to provide a real **public benefit** to the community.
- It's making the rounds on **r/nottheonion** — the kind of headline that sounds fake but isn't.

The Debate Starter

- What would it even take to prove your local police department is worth keeping open?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.spokesman.com/stories/2026/sep/16/texas-police-department-ordered-to-close-for-faili/

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *London man hits 50,000 golf balls to raise awareness for Palestinians killed in Gaza war*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Quirky, visual stunt (50,000 golf balls) tied to a highly charged geopolitical topic gives it a novelty hook that can travel well beyond r/upliftingnews despite starting at zero.

The Angle: *It's a wild, oddly specific challenge, but it's tied to one of the biggest ongoing stories in the world - that mix of quirky stunt and heavy real-world cause is exactly what gets people talking and sharing.*

- A man in **London** took on a marathon physical challenge: hitting **50,000 golf balls**.
- The goal wasn't a record attempt for its own sake - it's meant to raise awareness for **Palestinians killed in the Gaza war**.
- The stunt is spreading online as a feel-good/awareness crossover story out of the UK.

The Debate Starter

- Does a stunt like this actually move the needle on awareness, or is the challenge itself what gets remembered instead of the cause?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 58/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/london/article/london-man-hits-50000-golf-balls-to-raise-awareness-for-palestinians-killed-in-gaza-war/

■ *Researchers used Claude to hack OpenAI*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): An AI-vs-AI hacking story (Claude used to breach OpenAI) is a surprising, headline-ready angle that plugs directly into the ongoing AI-safety news cycle.
The Angle: *Two of the biggest names in AI, and one's chatbot allegedly got used to break into the other — it's the kind of tech-rivalry headline that sounds made up but is trending precisely because it's real.*

- Story is circulating out of **r/nottheonion** — the subreddit for real headlines that read like satire.
- The claim: **researchers** used **Anthropic's Claude** to hack **OpenAI**.
- Beyond the headline, hard details are thin — worth a light touch until more comes out.

The Irony Alert

- Would you trust one AI chatbot to go snoop on its biggest rival's turf?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 61/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality - 25 penalty (used within the last 30 days)) -> STRONG

URL: https://arstechnica.com/ai/2026/09/researchers-used-claude-to-hack-openai/

■ *Melissa McCarthy Says Murder of JonBenét Ramsey Role Drew Her Back After 'a Lot of Years Not Working'*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Melissa McCarthy's name plus the perpetually hot JonBenét Ramsey true-crime hook is a strong pairing for shareability.
The Angle: *A beloved comedy star getting real about a career dry spell — and revealing it took a dark true-crime project to pull her back in — is the kind of Hollywood honesty that always gets people talking.*

- **Melissa McCarthy** is opening up about landing a role tied to the **JonBenét Ramsey** murder case
- She says the project came after **"a lot of years not working"**
- The comment frames it as a comeback moment sparked by a true-crime dramatization

The Debate Starter

- Does it surprise you that an A-lister like Melissa McCarthy said she went years without steady work?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 58/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://people.com/melissa-mccarthy-explains-why-yes-jonbenet-ramsey-series-years-not-working-12131845

■ *'Backrooms' Surpasses $400 Million at Global Box Office*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): An internet creepypasta franchise crossing $400M at the box office is a genuinely surprising trend-alignment story (meme culture eating Hollywood) that's easy to package as a 'wow' stat.
The Angle: *This started as an internet horror legend — the eerie 'liminal space' meme that freaked out half of TikTok — and it just crossed $400 million worldwide, proving Hollywood can turn even the weirdest corners of the internet into a box office monster.*

- **'Backrooms'** has now topped **$400 million** at the global box office.
- The story traces back to an internet creepypasta about endless, empty liminal spaces that unsettled millions online before it ever hit a movie screen.

The Watercooler Angle

- An internet meme just outgrossed movies with A-list casts and real budgets — what's the next viral rabbit hole that deserves a $400 million adaptation?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/box-office/backrooms-box-office-milestone-400-million-1236870141/

■ *Fourth Marineland whale dies after relocation, third at Shedd Aquarium in Chicago https://t.co/m0a1xdRQLM*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A fourth whale death after relocation extends an emotionally charged animal-welfare saga that tends to reignite outrage each time a new

death is reported.
The Angle: *A cross-border animal welfare story North America's already been watching closely - beluga whales relocated from a Canadian marine park keep dying at their new US home, and that pattern is what's going to get people talking.*

- A **fourth** beluga whale has died following relocation from **Marineland**
- **Three** of those four deaths happened after the whale arrived at **Shedd Aquarium** in **Chicago**
- The deaths follow **Marineland**'s push to relocate its beluga population amid years of animal welfare scrutiny

The Debate Starter

- Is this just bad luck with a tough species to move, or proof these whales never should've been relocated in the first place?

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 52/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 5 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2102166018390913408

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 16 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: ‘So Much to Be Grateful for’ - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at ‘Josie and the Pussycats’ 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces ‘Songs in the Key of Life’ 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani’s toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live’s 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "‘Practical Magic 2’ Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of “Sunday in the Park With George” has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "‘Sunday in the Park With George’ revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)

- 2 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-21 11:41 PM